PLINTHWORK

Plumb
BY PLINTHWORK

Plinthwork Brandbook

> Plinthwork · **Plumb**, the project assistant · Version 1.0 · November 2026 The source of truth for code is `styles/tokens.css` (tokens) and `components/ui` (components). The live reference is `/design-system`. This document is written so it can be pasted into any design or coding tool.

1. Who we are

Company	**Plinthwork**: software for the people who build buildings.
Mission	Give everyone on site the right answer from the project's own documents, in seconds, with the page it came from.
Product	**Plumb**: an AI assistant for construction projects. Site managers, project managers and foremen ask a question ("What concrete class is specified for the basement walls?"), get a short answer with citations to the project documents, and Plumb remembers key facts: decisions, deadlines, contacts and changes.
Personality	**Precise · Calm · Dependable · Practical**
Name logic	A *plinth* is the solid base a structure stands on. A *plumb* line is how you prove something is true and vertical. The product checks answers against the documents.

Brand direction: precise, calm and trustworthy, built for the outdoors. High contrast that stays readable in sunlight, and large touch targets for people wearing gloves. It looks like a well-made measuring tool, not a SaaS dashboard. No hazard stripes, no yellow-and-black, no generic SaaS blue.

What makes it recognisable at a glance:

1. **Spruce green + hi-vis lime** on warm **concrete** neutrals (not grey-blue, not black-and-white).
2. **Condensed headings** (Barlow Condensed), like site signage and drawing title blocks.
3. **Crisp 4px corners and 2px borders** instead of soft 8–12px rounded cards.
4. **The hi-vis focus ring**: a dark 2px line inside a 3px lime halo.
5. **The measuring-tape rule**: a row of tick marks under page titles (`rule-ticks`).
6. **48px controls** everywhere by default.

2. Logo

Files are in `/public/brand` (text converted to outlines, so no fonts needed):

File	Use
`plinthwork-mark.svg` / `plinthwork-mark-dark.svg`	Square mark, 64×64. App icon, favicon (`app/icon.svg`), avatars.
`plinthwork-wordmark.svg` / `plinthwork-wordmark-dark.svg`	Company lockup: mark + PLINTHWORK. Marketing, documents.
`plumb-wordmark.svg` / `plumb-wordmark-dark.svg`	Product lockup: mark + "Plumb" + BY PLINTHWORK. Product UI header.

In the app, use `<LogoMark />` / `<ProductLogo />` from `components/brand/logo.tsx`. They draw with tokens, so they switch theme automatically.

The mark is a spruce tile with a stepped plinth (the base), a plumb line, and a lime plumb bob that just touches the plinth: *true, checked, grounded.*

- Clear space: at least ¼ of the mark's height on every side.
- Minimum size: mark 16px (favicon), wordmarks 24px tall.
- Light backgrounds use the light files; dark backgrounds (`--background` dark, photos) use `-dark`.
- Never recolour, rotate, outline, add shadows or put the mark on lime.

3. Colour

All colours are CSS variables in `styles/tokens.css`, mapped to Tailwind utilities (`bg-primary`, `text-foreground-muted`, `border-border-strong`, …). **Tailwind's default palette is switched off**, so `bg-blue-500` or `text-black` do nothing in this project.

3.1 Primitive palette

Family	Token	Hex	Notes
Spruce (primary)	`--spruce-950`	`#0B2620`	
	`--spruce-900`	`#113A31`	
	`--spruce-800`	`#164B3F`	primary hover
	`--spruce-700`	**`#1B5E4F`**	**brand primary**
	`--spruce-600`	`#237361`	
	`--spruce-500`	`#2E8C76`	
	`--spruce-400`	`#5BAE98`	
	`--spruce-300`	`#8FCBB9`	primary in dark mode
	`--spruce-200`	`#BFE3D7`	
	`--spruce-100`	`#DDF0E9`	primary-subtle
	`--spruce-50`	`#EEF7F3`	
Lime (accent)	`--lime-700`	`#4A6300`	lime *text* on light
	`--lime-600`	`#6F8F0A`	
	`--lime-500`	`#A3CC1A`	
	`--lime-400`	`#BFE635`	accent hover
	`--lime-300`	**`#CDEF52`**	**brand accent / focus halo / highlight**
	`--lime-100`	`#F0FBCB`	
Concrete (neutrals)	`--concrete-0`	`#FFFFFF`	cards (light)
	`--concrete-25`	`#F7F5F0`	page background (light)
	`--concrete-50`	`#EFECE5`	sunken / hover
	`--concrete-100`	`#E6E2D9`	
	`--concrete-200`	`#D6D2C8`	borders
	`--concrete-300`	`#B9B4A8`	
	`--concrete-400`	`#8A867C`	input borders

Family	Token	Hex	Notes
	`--concrete-500`	`#6B6862`	subtle text
	`--concrete-600`	`#4F4D48`	muted text
	`--concrete-700…900`	`#3A3935` `#262624` `#1A1B19`	
Night (dark surfaces)	`--night-950…100`	`#0A0F0D` `#0E1513` `#151E1B` `#1C2723` `#2B3833` `#5E6C66` `#8E9993` `#B2BCB6` `#EDF1EC`	
Ink	`--ink`	`#141A17`	darkest text. **Never pure black.**

3.2 Semantic tokens (what components use)

Token (Tailwind)	Light	Dark	Use
`background`	`#F7F5F0`	`#0E1513`	Page
`surface`	`#FFFFFF`	`#151E1B`	Cards, tables, inputs
`surface-raised`	`#FFFFFF`	`#1C2723`	Menus, dialogs, sheets
`surface-sunken`	`#EFECE5`	`#0A0F0D`	Table headers, wells, code
`surface-hover` / `surface-active`	`#EFECE5` / `#E6E2D9`	`#1C2723` / `#2B3833`	Hover / pressed rows and ghost buttons
`overlay`	ink @ 56%	`#050807` @ 72%	Behind dialogs and sheets
`foreground`	`#141A17`	`#EDF1EC`	Body text, headings
`foreground-muted`	`#4F4D48`	`#B2BCB6`	Secondary text
`foreground-subtle`	`#6B6862`	`#8E9993`	Meta, placeholders, captions
`foreground-disabled`	`#8A867C`	`#5E6C66`	Disabled text (exempt from AA)
`border` / `border-strong`	`#D6D2C8` / `#8A867C`	`#2B3833` / `#5E6C66`	Dividers / emphasised edges
`input-border`	`#8A867C`	`#5E6C66`	Form control borders (≥3:1)
`primary`	`#1B5E4F`	`#8FCBB9`	Primary buttons, links, active nav
`primary-hover` / `-active`	`#164B3F` / `#113A31`	`#BFE3D7` / `#DDF0E9`	
`primary-foreground`	`#FFFFFF`	`#0B2620`	Text on primary
`primary-subtle` / `-foreground`	`#DDF0E9` / `#113A31`	`#173229` / `#BFE3D7`	Selected rows, active nav, tinted badges
`accent`	`#CDEF52`	`#CDEF52`	The one hi-vis action, highlights
`accent-foreground`	`#141A17`	`#141A17`	Text on lime (always dark)
`accent-subtle` / `-foreground`	`#F0FBCB` / `#4A6300`	`#27310D` / `#CDEF52`	

Token (Tailwind)	Light	Dark	Use
`success` / `-subtle` / `-subtle-foreground`	`#2E7D32` / `#E3F3E1` / `#1E5A22`	`#7CC97F` / `#16301A` / `#A7DFA9`	Passed inspections, saved
`warning` / `-subtle` / `-subtle-foreground`	`#E8A317` / `#FDF0D5` / `#6E3F00`	`#F2B544` / `#33260B` / `#F7D08A`	Superseded info, delays (amber, not hazard yellow)
`danger` / `-subtle` / `-subtle-foreground`	`#B42318` / `#FDE7E4` / `#8A1A12`	`#FF8A7A` / `#3A1512` / `#FFB4A9`	Errors, destructive actions
`info` / `-subtle` / `-subtle-foreground`	`#2B5C8A` / `#E2ECF6` / `#1D4268`	`#8DB8E8` / `#132538` / `#B5D2F2`	Neutral notices (muted steel, not SaaS blue)
`ring-inner` + `ring`	`#141A17` + `#CDEF52`	`#0E1513` + `#CDEF52`	Focus ring (inner line + halo)
`highlight` / `-foreground`	`#CDEF52` / `#141A17`	same	Highlighted text, e.g. a quote in a source
`skeleton`	`#E6E2D9`	`#1C2723`	Loading placeholders

Each semantic colour has a matching `*-foreground` meant to sit on it. Always pair them: `bg-danger text-danger-foreground`, `bg-info-subtle text-info-subtle-foreground`.

3.3 Accessibility: WCAG AA contrast

Every text/background pair below is checked automatically by `npm run contrast` (`scripts/check-contrast.mjs`, which reads `tokens.css` directly). **All 54 pairs pass WCAG 2.2 AA** in both modes: at least 4.5:1 for text, and 3:1 for UI boundaries and the focus ring. Most body text pairs exceed AAA (7:1) for sunlight readability.

Mode	Pair	Colours	Ratio	Needs	Result
light	`foreground on background`	#141a17 / #f7f5f0	16.20:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`foreground on surface`	#141a17 / #ffffff	17.65:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`foreground on surface-sunken`	#141a17 / #efece5	14.96:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`foreground-muted on background`	#4f4d48 / #f7f5f0	7.75:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`foreground-muted on surface`	#4f4d48 / #ffffff	8.44:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`foreground-subtle on surface`	#6b6862 / #ffffff	5.55:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`foreground-subtle on background`	#6b6862 / #f7f5f0	5.10:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`primary-foreground on primary`	#ffffff / #1b5e4f	7.61:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`primary-foreground on primary-hover`	#ffffff / #164b3f	9.94:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`primary on surface`	#1b5e4f / #ffffff	7.61:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`primary on background`	#1b5e4f / #f7f5f0	6.98:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`primary-subtle-foreground on primary-subtle`	#113a31 / #ddf0e9	10.59:1	4.5:1	PASS

Mode	Pair	Colours	Ratio	Needs	Result
light	`accent-foreground on accent`	#141a17 / #cdef52	13.50:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`accent-foreground on accent-hover`	#141a17 / #bfe635	12.26:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`accent-subtle-foreground on accent-subtle`	#4a6300 / #f0fbcb	6.30:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`success-foreground on success`	#ffffff / #2e7d32	5.13:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`success-subtle-foreground on success-subtle`	#1e5a22 / #e3f3e1	7.15:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`warning-foreground on warning`	#141a17 / #e8a317	8.14:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`warning-subtle-foreground on warning-subtle`	#6e3f00 / #fdf0d5	7.84:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`danger-foreground on danger`	#ffffff / #b42318	6.57:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`danger on surface`	#b42318 / #ffffff	6.57:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`danger-subtle-foreground on danger-subtle`	#8a1a12 / #fde7e4	7.92:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`info-foreground on info`	#ffffff / #2b5c8a	7.00:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`info-subtle-foreground on info-subtle`	#1d4268 / #e2ecf6	8.65:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`highlight-foreground on highlight`	#141a17 / #cdef52	13.50:1	4.5:1	PASS
light	`input-border on surface`	#8a867c / #ffffff	3.63:1	3:1	PASS
light	`ring-inner on background`	#141a17 / #f7f5f0	16.20:1	3:1	PASS
dark	`foreground on background`	#edf1ec / #0e1513	16.20:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`foreground on surface`	#edf1ec / #151e1b	14.91:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`foreground on surface-sunken`	#edf1ec / #0a0f0d	16.92:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`foreground-muted on background`	#b2bcb6 / #0e1513	9.48:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`foreground-muted on surface`	#b2bcb6 / #151e1b	8.73:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`foreground-subtle on surface`	#8e9993 / #151e1b	5.78:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`foreground-subtle on background`	#8e9993 / #0e1513	6.28:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`primary-foreground on primary`	#0b2620 / #8fcbb9	8.70:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`primary-foreground on primary-hover`	#0b2620 / #bfe3d7	11.57:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`primary on surface`	#8fcbb9 / #151e1b	9.25:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`primary on background`	#8fcbb9 / #0e1513	10.05:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`primary-subtle-foreground on primary-subtle`	#bfe3d7 / #173229	9.96:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`accent-foreground on accent`	#141a17 / #cdef52	13.50:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`accent-foreground on accent-hover`	#141a17 / #bfe635	12.26:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`accent-subtle-foreground on accent-subtle`	#cdef52 / #27310d	10.49:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`success-foreground on success`	#141a17 / #7cc97f	8.84:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`success-subtle-foreground on success-subtle`	#a7dfa9 / #16301a	9.36:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`warning-foreground on warning`	#141a17 / #f2b544	9.64:1	4.5:1	PASS

Mode	Pair	Colours	Ratio	Needs	Result
dark	`warning-subtle-foreground on warning-subtle`	#f7d08a / #33260b	10.08:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`danger-foreground on danger`	#141a17 / #ff8a7a	7.71:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`danger on surface`	#ff8a7a / #151e1b	7.43:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`danger-subtle-foreground on danger-subtle`	#ffb4a9 / #3a1512	9.53:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`info-foreground on info`	#141a17 / #8db8e8	8.53:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`info-subtle-foreground on info-subtle`	#b5d2f2 / #132538	9.98:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`highlight-foreground on highlight`	#141a17 / #cdef52	13.50:1	4.5:1	PASS
dark	`input-border on surface`	#5e6c66 / #151e1b	3.09:1	3:1	PASS
dark	`ring on background`	#cdef52 / #0e1513	14.15:1	3:1	PASS

4. Typography

Google Fonts only, loaded with `next/font` in `styles/fonts.ts` (self-hosted at build time, no runtime calls to Google).

Role	Font	Why
Display & headings	**Barlow Condensed** 500/600/700	Narrow, engineered, like site signage and drawing title blocks. Fits long titles on phones.
Body & UI	**Atkinson Hyperlegible Next** (variable)	Designed by the Braille Institute for maximum character distinction (`Il1` , `0O`): readable in glare and at arm's length.
Mono	**Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono**	Document numbers (`ALD-SPEC-0310`), quantities, codes. Same family, same legibility.

Type scale (Tailwind class → spec)

Name	Class	Size / line-height · weight	Font
Display	`font-display text-display`	56/60 · 600, −0.01em	Barlow Condensed
Heading 1	`font-display text-h1`	40/44 · 600	Barlow Condensed
Heading 2	`font-display text-h2`	32/36 · 600	Barlow Condensed
Heading 3	`font-display text-h3`	24/30 · 600	Barlow Condensed
Heading 4	`text-h4`	20/28 · 700	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Body large	`text-body-lg`	18/28 · 400	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Body	`text-body`	16/24 · 400	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Body small	`text-body-sm`	14/20 · 400	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Label	`text-label`	15/20 · 700	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Caption	`text-caption`	13/18 · 400	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Overline	`text-overline uppercase`	12/16 · 700, +0.08em	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Code	`font-mono text-code`	14/20 · 400	Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono

Tailwind's default sizes (`text-sm` , `text-lg` , …) are switched off. `h1` – `h3` get `font-display` by default. Use the `Heading` and `Text` components for consistency. Body text never goes below 14px; 13px is only for captions and metadata.

5. Space, shape, depth, layout

Spacing. A 4px grid using Tailwind's numeric steps (`p-4` = 16px).

Step	1	2	3	4	5	6	8	10	12	16	20
px	4	8	12	16	20	24	32	40	48	64	80

Typical use: 8 inside controls, 12–16 between related items, 24 between groups, 32–56 between page sections.

Control & layout sizes.

Token	Value	Use
`control-sm`	40px	Dense desktop UI only (table toolbars, pagination)
`control-md`	**48px**	**Default** for buttons, inputs, nav items and menu rows. Glove-friendly.
`control-lg`	56px	Primary on-site actions on mobile (Ask, Save)
`icon-xs/sm/md/lg/xl`	14 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32px	Icon sizes
`sidebar`	272px	App sidebar
`topbar`	64px	Top bar
`sheet` / `sheet-lg`	480 / 720px	Side panels
`content`	1280px	Max content width

Radius. Crisp, measured corners: `rounded-xs` 2px (checkbox, kbd) · `rounded-sm` **4px** (buttons, inputs, badges) · `rounded-md` 6px (cards, menus) · `rounded-lg` 10px (dialogs, sheets) · `rounded-full` (avatars, switches, chips). Nothing above 10px except pills.

Borders. 2px is the standard (cards, inputs, menus); 1px only for table row dividers.

Elevation. Warm, low shadows. Hierarchy comes mostly from borders and surface colour.

Token	Use
`shadow-xs`	Cards at rest
`shadow-sm`	Hovered interactive cards, toasts
`shadow-md`	Menus, popovers, selects
`shadow-lg`	Dialogs, sheets

Breakpoints. `sm` 640 · `md` 768 (tables replace card lists) · `lg` 1024 (sidebar becomes fixed; below it is a drawer) · `xl` 1280 · `2xl` 1536. Design mobile-first.

Motion. 140ms with `cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)` for state changes, 220ms for sheets sliding in. No bouncing. Everything respects `prefers-reduced-motion`.

6. Iconography

- Library: **lucide-react**, stroke width **2** (default). Never mix in other icon sets.
- Sizes: 16px inline with small text, **20px default** in buttons, inputs and nav, 24px in large buttons, 32px in empty states.
- Icons inherit `currentColor`. Use `text-foreground-subtle` for decorative icons.
- Decorative icons get `aria-hidden`. Icon-only buttons must use `IconButton`, which requires a `label` (used as the aria-label and tooltip).
- Typical icons: documents `FileText`, chat `MessageSquareText`, search `Search`, memory `Brain`, pin `Pin`, decision `CircleCheck`, deadline `CalendarClock`, contact `UserRound`, change `FilePen`.

7. Tone of voice

Plumb talks like a sharp, experienced site engineer: it gives the answer first, names the source, and doesn't waste anyone's time.

Principles

1. **Answer first.** Lead with the fact, then the detail. "C32/40, XD3." not "Great question! Based on my analysis..."
2. **Show the source.** Every claim points to a document and page. If it isn't in the documents, say so plainly.
3. **Plain site language.** Use the trade's words (pour, RFI, change order, snag), not tech words (query, entity, sync).
4. **Calm, never alarming.** State problems and the next step. No exclamation marks, no blame.
5. **Short.** Buttons are verbs (2–3 words). Messages are one sentence where possible. Use sentence case everywhere.
6. **Respect the expert.** Never patronise, never over-explain, and never pretend to be sure when it isn't.

Before → after

Where	Before	After
Primary button	Submit	**Ask Plumb**
Destructive button	OK	**Delete memory**
Empty state (documents)	No data found.	**No documents yet.** When specs, diaries and reports are added to this project, they'll be listed here.
Empty state (memory)	You have no items.	**Nothing remembered yet.** Pin a fact from any answer and it shows up here.
No answer	Sorry, an error occurred while processing your request.	**I couldn't find this in your documents.**
Load error	Error 500: Request failed.	**Couldn't load documents.** Check your connection and try again.
Streaming interrupted	Something went wrong!!!	**The connection dropped mid-answer.** Try again; your question is still here.
Delete confirmation	Are you sure? This action cannot be undone.	**Delete this memory?** Plumb will stop using it in answers. You can't undo this.
Success toast	Operation completed successfully!	**Memory pinned.**
Loading	Please wait while we fetch your data...	**Reading 32 documents...**
Superseded source	Note: conflicting information detected.	**This spec was changed by CO-004 on 14 Mar 2026.**

8. Do's and don'ts

1. **Do** use only semantic tokens (`bg-primary`, `text-foreground-muted`). **Don't** write hex values, `rgb()`, Tailwind palette colours or arbitrary values like `bg-[#1b5e4f]` in components.
2. **Never use pure black (`#000`) or pure-black text.** The darkest colour is Ink `#141A17`.
3. **Primary buttons are always Spruce with white text** (light mode). Use one per screen at most.
4. **Lime is a signal, not a theme.** Use it for the single most important on-site action (e.g. "Ask Plumb"), highlights and the focus ring. **Never put lime text on a light background**, never use lime for large areas, and always put dark text on lime.
5. **Don't** use yellow-and-black hazard stripes, traffic cones, or any construction clichés. **Don't** use SaaS blue for primary actions or links.
6. **Headings are Barlow Condensed; everything you read is Atkinson Hyperlegible Next.** Never set paragraphs, buttons or labels in the condensed face.
7. **Every control is at least 48px tall** on touch layouts (40px only in dense desktop tables). Keep 8px or more between adjacent tap targets.
8. **Corners are 4px on controls and 6px on cards.** Don't use large soft radii (12px+) or pill-shaped buttons.
9. **Borders are 2px.** Use borders and surfaces for hierarchy; keep shadows low and warm.
10. **Never rely on colour alone.** Status always has an icon or text label too (badges, alerts, errors).
11. **Every async view has four states**: loading skeleton, error with a retry, an empty state with a next step, and content. Never a blank screen or a bare spinner for a whole page.
12. **Focus is always visible.** Use the hi-vis `focus-visible:focus-ring`. Never `outline: none` without a replacement.
13. **Write sentence case**, with verbs on buttons and no exclamation marks. Dates read like `14 Mar 2026`; document codes are set in mono.
14. **Use `/components/ui` first.** Don't restyle a component inline to make a variant; add the variant to the component (with design-system approval).
15. **Dark mode is designed, not inverted.** In dark mode, primary becomes light spruce with dark text. Test both.

9. Implementation quick reference

```
// Buttons
<Button>Save changes</Button>                        // primary
<Button variant="accent" size="lg">Ask Plumb</Button> // the one hi-vis action
<Button variant="secondary">Cancel</Button>
<Button variant="danger">Delete memory</Button>
<IconButton label="Pin fact"><Pin /></IconButton>

// Text
<Heading size="h2">Documents</Heading>
<Text tone="muted" size="sm">Updated 3 days ago</Text>

// Colour utilities
bg-surface border-2 border-border rounded-md shadow-xs text-foreground
bg-primary-subtle text-primary-subtle-foreground
bg-highlight text-highlight-foreground   // highlighted quote
focus-visible:focus-ring
```

Fonts: `font-display`, `font-sans` (default), `font-mono`. Sizes: `text-display, text-h1…h4, text-body-lg, text-body, text-body-sm, text-label, text-caption, text-overline, text-code`. Heights: `h-control-sm|md|lg`. Icons: `size-icon-sm|md|lg`.